

No Crying in Greenrest

Tuesday, 11 August 2026

Canonical GM record. Player-safe twin: [recap.html](#). Threads/bookkeeping: [gm-notes.md](#).

Timeline

The doorstep. Picking up at the tree line above Greenrest. Survival checks at the trailhead: Morgash (12) found animal prints circling the path where it leaves the forest — two legs, four, six, eight, impossible to say — and they turn back into the trees; whatever it is won't approach the town. Jetten (10) befuddled; Thomas rolled a 2. Morgash warned the party out loud.

The welcome. Down into the village: orchards, flourishing fields, woodsmoke, prosperity — richer-feeling than Daggerford. A crowd gathered before they reached the square, and **Mayor Oswin Applewhite** greeted them "like family coming home." Tour of the town: the Long Rest (inn, Ambrose), smithy, church of the Earth Mother, the Mayor's Tower (his home — "the mayor always lives up at the top of the hill, it's tradition"), town square, brew house, Selma's apothecary, dockside on the lake, the Full Larder (Mother Wend), the Hedgewatch garrison (~50 strong). Map handed out as a player journal. Free lodging, free food, free ale — "we love our guests, you don't have to worry about a penny here."

Key exchanges at the Long Rest:

- Oswin on the Broken Heart: a relic, adventurers came "several months ago" looking for it — the **Kestrel Company** — four ruins, never came back. "Sadly life is good here... as long as everything is status quo I'm happy."
- Oswin claims **there is no crying in Greenrest** — delivered as a boast.
- Thomas, asked whether they'd followed a will-o'-wisp: "I'm going to take the fifth on that one, Oswin."
- **Constable Warrenholt** cut in on the monster talk, then whispered: *"I think I know the mistakes those adventurers made. Come to the barracks — I don't want to bother Oswin with such things."*
- Oswin has been mayor ~15 years, never left the valley, no elections — "the town just sort of votes whoever wants to do the bureaucracy."

Pip. Halfling child at the inn porch ("I'm taller than you, buddy" to Gren). Gren's Minor Illusion green dragon: never seen one, hopes he never does. Then unprompted: *"Did the black cats follow you too?"* — big black cats with too many legs, seen circling the town when the Kestrel Company was here and again with this party (an hour before they emerged), and he never told anyone "because I don't want to bother them." Showed them the spot — exactly the trail they came in on. Refused a gold piece ("I honestly don't need gold, I have everything I need here"). Tipped them that Selma "doesn't shut up" about the Broken Heart. ⚠️ *Retconned 2026-08-25 (owner): void — Selma does not know the Broken Heart, and nobody in town does (plot §3.2). If quoted back at the table: Pip mixed up which adult retold the Kestrels' relic-talk.*

Shopping — the Full Larder (Mother Wend). Knew all four names before they entered. Buyback at 50%. Traffic: Morgash sold his battleaxe, bought a pike (5 gp), greataxe (30 gp), and dice (1 sp). Thomas sold a longsword, the bolt of fine cloth, and a cask of southern wine; bought 15 javelins + 6 torches, and **Gauntlets of Ogre Power — 400 gp** (STR 19; party pooled gold). Jetten bought 10 caltrops, a bullseye lantern, 20 arrows, sold the spare quiver, and took **Bracers of Archery — 400 gp**. Gren sold the pouch of cut gems (45 gp) and bought the **Wand of Magic Missiles — 400 gp**. Thomas un-attuned the **Stone of Good Luck and handed it to Gren** (who attuned it — "it's good for concentration"). Gren gave his 2 healing potions to Morgash. The **Pearl of Power** stayed on the shelf — Gren wanted it but was broke. (Gold accounting got platinum-mangled mid-stream; DM added ~100 gp to the stash to square it.)

The garrison. Warrenholt, plainly: his scouts report **displacer beasts**. His theory — they stalked the Kestrel Company, waited for a weak moment, and killed them **in an old temple southeast of town**; the scouts saw the battle-sign and the company's cached supplies and wouldn't go closer. "They've latched onto you like they did the others. They cannot be deterred until their quarry is slain. **Kill them first** — at a moment of your choosing, at full strength — or come home wounded some night and be jumped." His men defend the town only: "we don't leave the town, and they don't come in here." Pointed them southeast.

Coll. Thomas buttonholed him at the inn. Lifelong local; parents in the south cottage. *"It hasn't been right since"* the Kestrel Company — they complained they weren't sleeping well, and it reminded him of being a kid with bad dreams **before Selma "helped him out."** Confirmed the whole town takes the sleep-potion weekly from childhood ("as soon as we're old enough to dream"). Thomas read his Greenrest Tonic label to the party on the spot — same seventh-day cadence. Gren, deciding: *"Let's spend the night without drinking the tonic. Something's fishy about this town."*

The night of dreams (first Greenrest night, no tonic). All four dreamed of the same figure: a pale woman shaped like a white tree, hair of leaves/branches, weeping — and her grief bled into each of them personally:

- **Thomas** — the murder of his wife and children; grief underneath the oath of vengeance.

- **Morgash** — Lae'zel's goodbye in Baldur's Gate ("I cannot love someone in this world... goodbye, my Morgash") and the red dragon carrying her away.
- **Gren** — the Misty Forest village elders sending him away; the suspicion it was the spellfire; "cast out, unwanted, unloved."
- **Jetten** — his sister, dead long ago, and the cruelty of outliving her — **and his moonstone necklace glowed bright green while he dreamed, eyes open in trance.**

Morning: everyone shared their dream except Morgash, who admitted the woman but kept the details ("I won't give details about my broken heart"). Gren rolled a **natural 20 Religion (22)**, Thomas 20: the figure is a **dryad** — fey, immortal, rotating life between elf-form and tree. Thomas connected it immediately: *the dead tree in the square*. Morgash's "life is not perfect" table-speech earned an inspiration point.

The gray tree. Town square, morning. **Four guards** posted on a dead tree. Their orders (from the constable and the mayor): don't let anyone destroy it, don't let anyone **chip the bark**, watch it. Guard: born here, the tree has "always been like this," they keep trying to revive it and nothing works — "the one thing that doesn't flourish; almost like a symbol of our town." Jetten's Nature check (2, twice tonight): "it's a dead tree." Thomas (15): not quite dead — sick, uncared-for. Morgash, loudly: four guards for a dead tree doesn't add up. Gren: "It might be her tree... and Selma's drugging the whole town. We talk to the apothecary after." (They never made it to Selma — displacer hunt took the day.)

The hunt — the old temple camp. Following Warrenholt's line southeast; the trail ends at a ruined temple: cold firepit, corpses, a chest, a debris pile — the Kestrel Company's last camp. Morgash checked for traps (Survival 9, Perception 17 — nothing); **Jetten's Perception 25** picked the first displacer beast out of the fog at 135 feet, prowling, watching, waiting for them to move.

The fight (~8 rounds, ~1h55m at the table; 3× displacer beast + 1 alpha, 2025 MM):

- Jetten opened at range through fog-cover disadvantage — his would-be crit slid off the displacement (20→normal hit, 9). Dread Ambusher second attack + first-round extra. The beast **howled for the pack**: two more + the **alpha** joined (initiative 19/16/8).
- Round-1 learning was brutal: displacement (disadvantage), Avoidance (Gren's Shatter — both saves made, **zero** damage; later Web — alpha passed two Dex saves and walked through), prone-on-rend, 10–15 ft tentacle reach, opportunity-attack geometry. **Jetten's Faerie Fire — the textbook displacement counter — also failed**: the one beast caught in the cube passed its Dex save (17), so the lantern later carried the whole counter-illusion load. A skulker rend/tentacle combo (24/23) mauled Jetten; a later rend **dropped him** — Gren's Subtle-Spell Cure Wounds (2nd lvl, 20) put him back on his feet, Spellfire Burst temp HP to Morgash as the rider.
- **Morgash** dashed the courtyard with Adrenaline Rush, ate the alpha's advantage rends, drank potion after potion (3), **hit 0 HP and stood at 1 on Relentless Endurance**, Second Wind (13), and killed **beast #1** with a Precision-Attack backswing after a graze ("double-back and slash it dead").

- **Thomas** was crit by a tentacle (4d6+4=19) down to **3 HP**, lost Bless; then his **Arcana 23** surfaced the answer: the **Lantern of Revealing**. Unhooded, the beasts "shrieked and raged" as displacement burned away in the 30-ft light — and the pack immediately learned the rule, disengaging to skirmish at the edge of the glow. Vow of Enmity (first use) + **Bane** (one beast failed; its –1d4 attacks missed everything — "that Bane really works wonders").
- **Beast #2**: Thomas's First Light + **Thunderous Smite** (10) blasted it 10 ft back (failed STR), triggering reactions from both melees — **Morgash's opportunity strike killed it mid-air**. "Excellently played."
- **Jetten** re-marked targets all fight (Hunter's Mark), landed a **natural-20 +1 Dagger crit (31 to hit)** in a Goldthorn/Nick double, and chip-healed with Healing Word ×3. Nick-order ruling made at the table (see gm-notes).
- **Gren** was the artillery and the medic: wand + slot Magic Missiles all night (the answer to displacement — no attack roll), upcast Healing Word, two Cure Wounds, Shield to bounce the alpha's rend off AC 20, and his **Fey-Touched free Bless** re-blessed the line late. Final volley: **3rd-level Magic Missile, five darts (18)** into the alpha.
- **The alpha** died on Thomas's turn — "use your chance to be a hero" — **First Light through the chest, Lathander's light exploding out of it** (17 to hit under Bless, 10 damage). Leaderless, **the last beast fled** and vanished into the forest.
- Mid-fight comedy: Morgash's mouse died (battery); the DM swung his greatsword for him and whiffed (8+3).

The spoils. Two caches at the camp, all to the party stash:

- Crate stamped "Full Larder": Silver Kestrel Locket, 2× Potion of Healing (Greater), 6× Jar of Greenrest Preserves, Fey Ring Cap, Everbloom Petal, Charcoal Sketch of a Weeping Woman, **Marn's Journal, Sera's Map of the Four Ruins**, 74 gp.
- Brush pile (the company's gear): **Maul of Momentum, Pearl of Power** ("Glad I didn't buy it" — Gren; "Good thing you didn't" — DM), Sera's Longbow / Shortsword / Studded Leather, Marn's Light Crossbow / Traveler's Clothes, **Brakk's Plate Armor, Claw-Rent**, 17× +1 Arrows, 12 bolts.
- Journals and map deliberately left for **reading between sessions / next time**.

The wrap. DM narration: the displacer threat is broken; the party walked back to Greenrest for a safe night's rest. **Next-site pick locked at the table: the caves** (the one the townsfolk pointed the Kestrel Company toward) — DM preps it for session 4.

Kill ledger (precision matters)

- Displacer beast #1 — **Morgash** (Precision Attack backswing).
- Displacer beast #2 — **Morgash** (opportunity attack as Thomas's Thunderous Smite hurled it back).

- **Alpha displacer beast** — **Thomas** (First Light through the chest).
- Displacer beast #3 — **fled** when the alpha died; not pursued.

Resource snapshot at wrap (see party-snapshots/2026-08-11.md)

Jetten 3/32 HP at fight's end; Morgash 29+7temp/48 after burning Relentless Endurance, Second Wind ×1(+1 refunded confusion), 3 potions; Thomas 27/32, Lay on Hands pool spent 25, potion; Gren one 1st-level slot left, no potions. Party potion stock nearly dry — 2× Greater from the crate are the reserve. All narratively restored by the town rest before next session.

Recorded at the table — transcribed & chronicled by the party scribe.